

My Role in the Team

Character **First**

SCIENTIFIC FOUNDATION: EVIDENCE PYRAMID

Systematic Review

Bruner et al. (2021), meta-analysis on role clarity and cohesion in youth teams: role clarity is the strongest predictor of both task cohesion and social cohesion in sports teams, with effect size $d=0.62$. *Journal of Sport Sciences*.

Longitudinal study

Eys et al. (2015), season-long study with 248 basketball players: role ambiguity is negatively linked to self-confidence and positively linked to anxiety throughout the season. *Sport, Exercise & Performance Psychology*.

Theoretical study

Carron & Eys (2012), Team Cohesion Model: role acceptance and role performance as two separate dimensions. Athletes who actively invest in their role perform significantly better.

GUIDANCE ROLE CIRCLE (GROUP EXERCISE)

- 1 Have the team stand in a circle. Explain: "We are going to name our contribution to this team one by one. Not what we can do technically well. But what you contribute as a person."
- 2 Each player says: "My contribution to this team is..." Start yourself as coach. This lowers the threshold and sets a good example.
- 3 After each player: one other player may add what they also see in that person. Positive only. Rules: no irony, no "yes but", only recognition.
- 4 Close with: "Everyone has a role. No one is unimportant. The question is: are you fulfilling your role as well as possible?"

COACH TIPS FOR THIS THEME

Tip 1: Role Compass scores are not a ranking. Actively emphasize that a Stable Force is just as valuable as a Leader. Cultures that only reward leaders create competition instead of cooperation.

Tip 2: Use roles in your daily coaching language. "Tom, you're our Engine today. You set the pace." This strengthens identity and gives direction without creating hierarchy.

Tip 3: Repeat the "Top 3 Contributions" exercise monthly through the season. Players who see themselves growing in character and contribution perform better and drop out less.

⚠ Watch out: players who consistently score low on all four roles may feel they don't fit or are not seen. Schedule an individual conversation.

TIMING

- ☐ Introduction of four roles: 5 minutes
- ☐ Individual Role Compass completion: 8 minutes
- ☐ Role Circle group exercise: 15 minutes
- ☐ Reflection and worksheet completion: 5 minutes
- ☐ Closing with quote and intention: 5 minutes